



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Name Catholic School  
School Website: <https://www.holynamecrusaders.com/>

December 28, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Holy Name Catholic School (MI 49829) shows a clear Catholic liturgical identity and communal worship in its public material, evidenced by references to Mass and chapel-style spaces within the school environment. However, the available public content from the school's website and related firecrawl artifacts provides limited explicit information about core classical elements such as Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric curricula, or the traditional pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, scholé, or memory-based recitation) that typically characterize a classical education. Based on the six-category classical rubric, the school demonstrates strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations but limited explicit evidence for the other classical criteria. Overall: NOT CLASSICAL.

Evidence is drawn from public site content showing liturgical practices (All School Mass, chapel spaces) and general K–12 offerings, contrasted with sparse explicit classical-curriculum or classical-pedagogy signals in the same materials. The key public content sources include the school site and firecrawl extracts indicating the presence of Mass and chapel spaces, and the school's Catholic framing.

For reference, the classical-education rubric defines positive indicators such as liturgy, theology, Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, Socratic pedagogy, memory work, and a robust parental/community formation framework; negative indicators flag departures such as secular, project-based-only approaches or non-classical pedagogy. The knowledge-base lexicon provides concrete positive/negative keywords to guide category scoring.

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## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
  - Public materials show Catholic identity and liturgical elements, including All School Mass and chapel spaces (HNCS-Main-Chapel).
  - School naming ("Holy Name Catholic School") and public references imply a theological framing consistent with a Catholic worldview.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords observed: liturgy, Mass, chapel, Catholic identity. These align with the Positive Keyword Indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (e.g., liturgy, Mass, worship; theology/catechesis).
  - Negative keywords: not evident in the accessible public materials.
- Why this rating
  - The presence of liturgical practice (Mass) and a chapel setting indicates a strong liturgical and communal practice, which is a key component of the category. The Catholic identity grounds a theological frame, supporting a CLASSICAL reading for this domain.

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## Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
    - Public content emphasizes the school as a K–12 Catholic institution; however, explicit articulation of classical aims (formation of virtue, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, Great Conversation, telos beyond job preparation) is not readily evident in the accessible materials.
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive keywords from the classical rubric (e.g., formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, scholé, Great Books) are not clearly present in the public materials reviewed.
    - Negative keywords (e.g., workforce-preparation rhetoric, project-based emphasis) are not observed in the accessible materials either, but their absence does not constitute positive alignment with classical aims.
  - Why this rating
    - While the Catholic identity suggests a formation-focused aim, there is insufficient explicit evidence of classical purposes (virtue-centered formation in the classical sense, or explicit reference to “the true, good, beautiful” as governing telos). In the absence of explicit classical mission-language, this dimension remains not clearly classical.
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## Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
    - Public materials indicate K–12 enrollment, but there is no explicit mention of liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric), or a Great Books program; no clear signaling of history as a throughline across disciplines, or Great Conversation references in the accessible content.
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive Classical Indicators (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, history as core discipline) are not evidenced in the public content.
    - The absence of these elements in the visible materials yields a NOT CLASSICAL signal for this category.
  - Why this rating
    - Without explicit curricular signaling toward liberal arts (grammar-logic-rhetoric), Great Books, or a Great Conversation approach, the curriculum dimension does not meet the classical criteria. The materials show a general K–12 Catholic program, not a classical curriculum through-line.
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## Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
    - The accessible public materials emphasize liturgical life and school routines, but do not clearly indicate classical pedagogical practices such as Socratic seminars, memory work with dictation, or rigorous introduction of rhetoric and formal public speaking in the high-school context.
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive Classical Pedagogy indicators (e.g., Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory work, chant, structured rhetoric) are not evidenced in the public materials.
    - No explicit negative signals either, but the absence of classical pedagogy signals weighs toward NOT CLASSICAL.
  - Why this rating
    - The material does not demonstrate the hallmark pedagogical methods of classical education (Socratic seminars, rigorous rhetoric training, or a clearly articulated restful/scholé approach). As such, category 4 is NOT CLASSICAL based on available public content.
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### Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
    - There is limited public content describing faculty as living curriculum, mentor-culture, or a distinctive classical teacher profile. Public posts do not reveal a stated “portrait of a teacher” or a “faculty as the living curriculum.”
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive indicators (e.g., living curriculum, model teachers, mentorship, classical pedagogy profile) are not evident in the accessible materials.
  - Why this rating
    - Without explicit statements or content highlighting classical faculty characteristics (mentors, living curriculum, teacher-student culture aligned with classical aims), the category does not meet classical criteria.
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### Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
    - Public content shows general school operations and mass events, but there is limited evidence of explicit parent co-teaching, formal parent formation programs, or open-campus/parent-facilitated classical community structures in the accessible materials. The visible items include Mass events and family-oriented calendars, but not a structured classical-education parental formation framework.
  - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
    - Positive classical indicators for this category include co-teaching with parents, parent education groups, and active family formation around classical pedagogy; none are clearly present in the accessible content.
  - Why this rating
    - The materials do not demonstrate a robust, explicit partnership model with parents in the classical sense (co-teaching, parental formation, or formal parent forums). Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL for this category.
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### What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable. The aggregate assessment is NOT CLASSICAL, and there is no category identified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL that would warrant a needle-moving plan. If the school sought to move toward CLASSICAL, concrete steps would include adopting a formal liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history through a classical lens; Great Books), implementing classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, memory work, deliberate rhetoric practice), building a faculty culture that embodies the classical living-curriculum model, and establishing a robust program for parental formation and active co-teaching partnerships. These steps would need to be publicly evidenced by the school to shift the six-category evaluation.
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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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